HelpLoop
-
Turning Everyday Help into a Rewarding Experience

HelpLoop is a gamified mobile application that connects people who need quick assistance with everyday tasks to helpers within the community. The app rewards participation through XP, credits, challenges, and team-based activities, creating a supportive and engaging experience while also encouraging users to give back through community donations and fundraising goals.

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Course and Section:

CSIS 3375 - 001

Team Lead:

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Requirements Gathering:

Purpose or objectives for Requirement Gathering User Study:

With this user study, we aim to better acknowledge and understand the needs, behaviour, and expectations of potential users before designing the final HelpLoop application. This will help identify how users prefer to request help, offer support, communicate, receive updates and stay motivated within the platform.

The objectives of this user studies are:

- To understand the characteristics of potential HelpLoop users, including their daily routines, preferences, and comfort with mobile apps.
- To identify how users currently look for quick help with small everyday tasks and how often they provide help to others.
- To learn about users' goals, motivations, and expectations when using a community-based support app.
- To learn whether users are willing to help others in exchange for rewards or recognition.
- To understand which gamification elements (points, badges, leaderboards, challenges) are most engaging.
- To understand which features users would expect in an app like HelpLoop.
- To understand what would encourage users to regularly use the platform.

Choice of User Study and User Sample

Chosen Method:

- We chose to use Online Google Form Survey because it allows us to collect responses from multiple users in a short amount of time and help us identify common patterns in user needs, preferences, and behaviors.

Target Users:

- College Students as they are more likely to need and provide quick help with study related work, writing or technical issues.
- Freelancers and young adults who want to earn money by helping others with their skills.
- Individuals who may need quick assistance in everyday activities.

Dual Perspective:

- Task Requesters: People who need help in tasks.
- Task Helpers: People who are willing to help others.

Draft of the User Study Survey:

Section 1: User Demographic

1. What is your age group?
    - Under 18
    - 18 - 22
    - 23 - 30
    - 30+

2. Which of the following best describes you?
    - College Student
    - University Student
    - Working Professional
    - Other

3. How often do you use mobile apps in your daily life?
    - Very often
    - Often
    - Sometimes
    - Rarely
    - Never

Section 2: Lifestyle and Current Behavior

4. How often do you need help in small everyday tasks?
    - Very often
    - Often
    - Sometimes
    - Rarely
    - Never

5. What type of small tasks do you commonly need help with?
    - Study-related tasks
    - Writing-related tasks
    - Technical problems
    - Household tasks
    - General daily tasks

6. When you need quick help, who do you usually rely on?
    - Friends
    - Classmates
    - Family
    - Online Communities
    - Paid Services

Section 3: User Goals and needs

7. How often do you help other people with small tasks?
    - Very often
    - Often
    - Sometimes
    - Rarely
    - Never

8. What usually makes it difficult to get quick help when you need it?
    - People are not available
    - It takes too long to get a response
    - I do not know who to ask
    - I do not fully trust others
    - The process feels inconvenient

9. How important is it for you to know the progress or status of your task once it has been posted?
    - Very important
    - Important
    - Neutral
    - Slightly important
    - Not important

Section 4: App features, motivation and engagement

10. What would make you feel comfortable asking someone for help through an app?
    - Verified Identity
    - Clear task details
    - Previous tasks history
    - A sense of safety and professionalism

11. Do you think a rewarding or interactive experience would make you more engaging in helping others?
    - Yes
    - Maybe
    - No

12. What type of cause would you be most willing to support through a community platform?
    - Student support
    - Local community support
    - Emergency support
    - Charitable causes
    - I would not be interested in supporting causes through an app

Section 5: Open ended question

13. In your opinion, what would make people more willing to help others with small tasks?

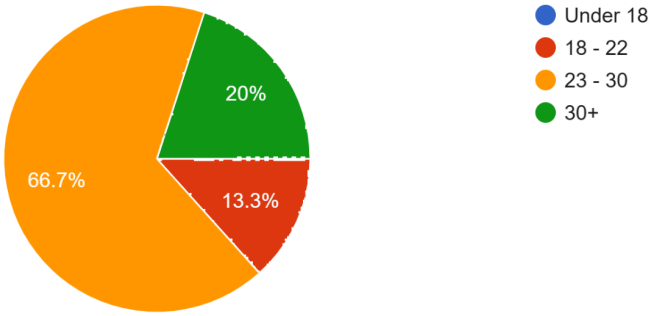
Data Visualization and Analysis:

Sample size

- Total Respondents: **15**

1. What is your age group?

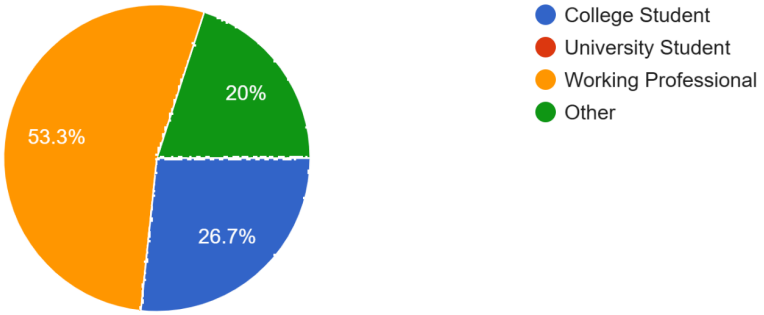
15 responses



Most respondents were in the 23–30 age group (66.7%), followed by 30+ (20%) and 18–22 (13.3%). No respondents were under 18. This shows that the survey mainly reflects the views of young adults and working-age users.

2. Which of the following best describes you?

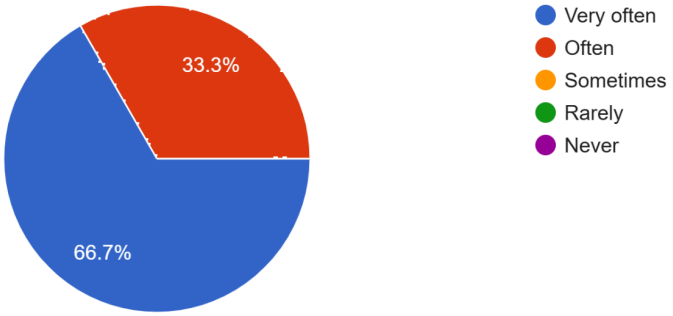
15 responses



The largest group of respondents were working professionals (53.3%), followed by college students (26.7%) and other users (20%). This suggests that the app will be used by students and working adults.

3. How often do you use mobile apps in your daily life?

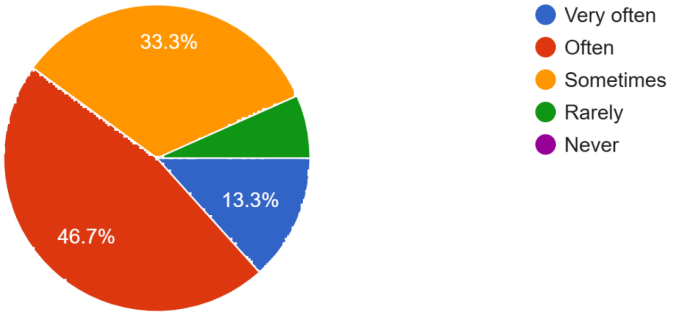
15 responses



All respondents reported using mobile apps regularly. 66.7% said very often and 33.3% said often. This means the target users are already comfortable with mobile-based platforms.

4. How often do you need help in small everyday tasks?

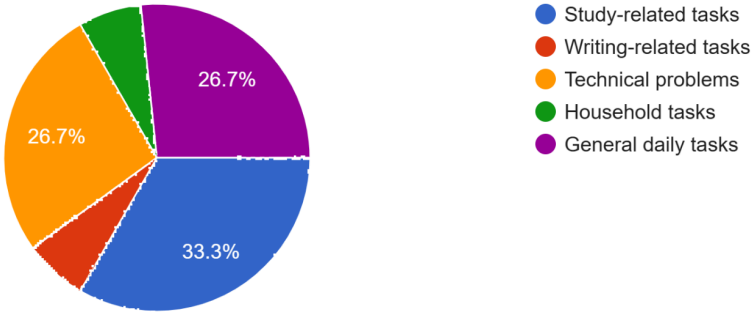
15 responses



46.7% selected often, 33.3% selected sometimes, and 13.3% selected very often. Only one respondent selected rarely. This indicates that the problem addressed by the app is relevant to many users.

5. What type of small tasks do you commonly need help with?

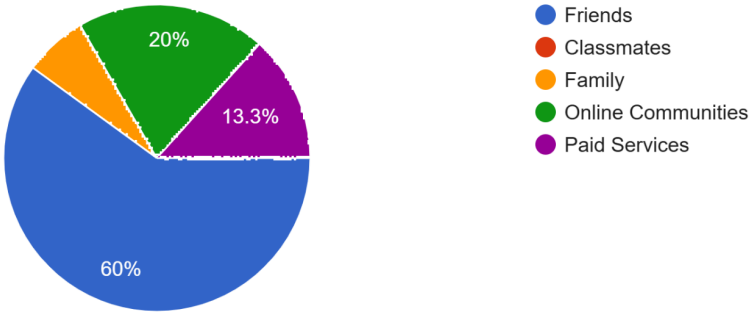
15 responses



The most common tasks were study-related tasks (33.3%), followed by technical problems (26.7%) and general daily tasks (26.7%). Writing-related and household tasks were selected less often. This suggests that the app should especially support study help, technical help, and general daily assistance.

6. When you need quick help, who do you usually rely on?

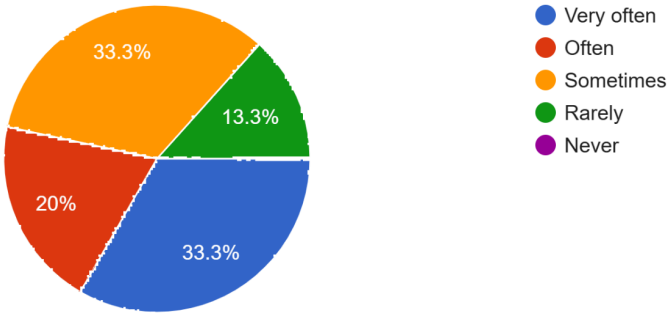
15 responses



Most users said they usually rely on friends (60%) when they need quick help. Some also rely on online communities (20%) and paid services (13.3%). This shows that users prefer familiar or trusted sources when seeking help.

7. How often do you help other people with small tasks?

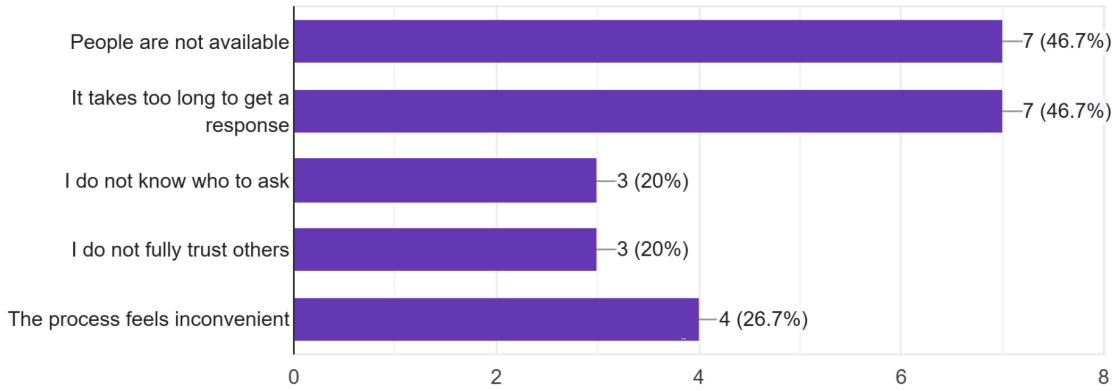
15 responses



Many respondents also said they help others. 33.3% selected very often, 20% selected often, and 33.3% selected sometimes. This suggests there is also a good potential helper base for the platform.

8. What usually makes it difficult to get quick help when you need it?

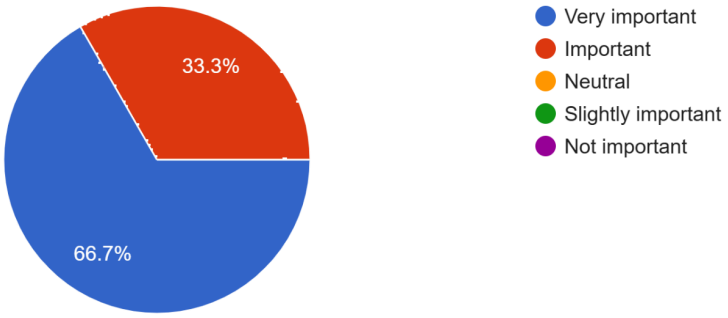
15 responses



This shows that speed, availability, and trust are important concerns for users.

9. How important is it for you to know the progress or status of your task once it has been posted?

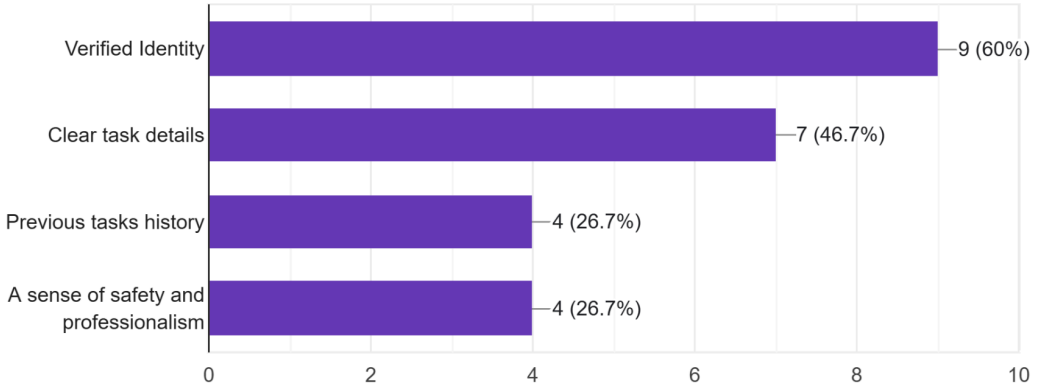
15 responses



All respondents considered task progress important. 66.7% selected very important and 33.3% selected important. This means the app should clearly show the status of each task after it is posted.

10. What would make you feel comfortable asking someone for help through an app?

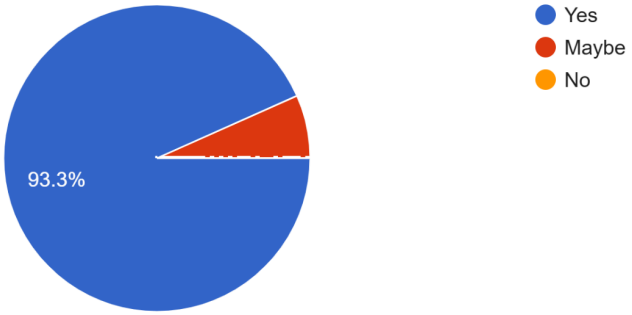
15 responses



This shows that trust and clarity are necessary for users to feel comfortable.

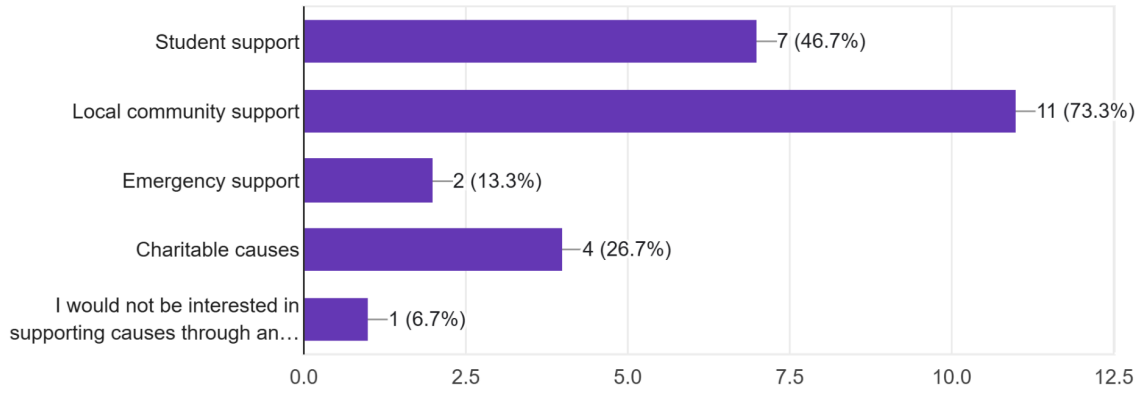
11. Do you think a rewarding or interactive experience would make you more engaging in helping others?

15 responses



Most respondents agreed that a rewarding or interactive experience would make them more willing to help others. 93.3% selected yes and 6.7% selected maybe. This strongly supports the use of rewards and gamification in the app.

12. What type of cause would you be most willing to support through a community platform?
15 responses



Users were most willing to support local community support (73.3%) and student support (46.7%). Some also selected charitable causes and emergency support. This suggests that community goals and donation-related features could be meaningful in the app.

Open Ended Responses- Many respondents mentioned that people are willing to help if there are rewards, appreciation or practical benefits. Some responses also highlighted the importance of trust, politeness, friendly attitude and clearly explained tasks.

Insights from the Results:

Findings from user study:

- From the data, we can say that the app will be helpful in all age groups and for all professions.
- According to the results, many respondents indicated they rely on friends or online communities when they need quick help. This suggests that people prefer trusted and familiar sources for assistance.
- A significant number of participants reported they sometimes or often need help with different tasks such as study related, technical or everyday tasks. This

confirms that there is a real need for a platform that allows people to request quick assistance.

- Most participants mentioned that availability of people and slow responses are common problems when trying to get help which indicates that the app should support fast task posting and quick notifications so helpers can respond quickly.
- Safety and trust are top priorities for users which tell us rating and reviews should be available.
- Users are mainly motivated by credits and rewards. This suggests that incorporating gamification features such as points, rewards, credits or recognition could increase user participation.
- Many respondents showed interest in supporting community related causes which suggests that the app could include features where users can donate earned credits toward community goals or causes.

How these insights affect the app requirements:

Based on these findings, following adjustments will be made to refine the app's features:

- The system will include notifications and quick response features to reduce waiting time.
- The app will implement trust and safety features such as verified accounts, user ratings, reviews and reporting users.
- A flexible reward system (credit, xp, achievements) will be designed to encourage people to help others.
- A task tracking system will be included so that users can see the progress of their tasks.
- The interface will be simple and easy to use so that people from different age groups can use it comfortably.

Requirements Generation

Personas and Scenarios:

Persona 1 - Karan Mehta (international student)

- Age 21
- International college student studying Computer Science
- Recently moved to Canada from India
- Finds it difficult to adjust to a different teaching style
- Usually studies late to keep up with classes
- Feels shy asking too many questions in class
- Wants quick help when stuck on small academic problems

Scenario - “have study related problems in new country”

1. We meet Karan in the library in the evening, sitting with his laptop and class notes open.
2. He is trying to finish a programming assignment, but he is stuck on one part and cannot understand why his code is not working.
3. Karan has been finding college a bit difficult because the way teachers explain things here is different from what he was used to before.
4. He does not want to keep searching random websites because that usually wastes a lot of his time.
5. Instead, he opens the app and posts a short request asking for help with a Java problem.
6. After a few minutes, another student accepts the request.
7. They talk through the app chat, and the helper explains the mistake in a simple way.
8. Karan fixes the problem and is able to continue his assignment.
9. He gives the helper a good rating and feels relieved that he did not have to struggle alone for hours.
10. Later on, he starts using the app again whenever he gets stuck on small study-related problems.

Persona 2 - Lina (multitalented freelancer)

- Age 26
- Freelance designer and digital creator
- Works from home
- Has skills in design, website editing, and document formatting
- Likes solving small problems for people
- Has flexible working hours
- Wants to make good use of her free time

Scenario - “want to utilize free time to learn and to earn more”

1. We meet Lina at home during a break between two freelance projects.
2. Since her work schedule changes a lot, she sometimes has an hour or two free in the middle of the day.
3. Instead of wasting that time, she likes doing something useful.
4. She comes across the app and notices that people are posting small tasks they need help with.
5. Lina makes a profile and adds the things she is good at, like design, formatting, and basic web help.
6. Soon she sees a request from a student who needs help making a presentation look cleaner.
7. Lina accepts the task and chats with the student through the app.
8. She helps improve the layout, spacing, and overall look of the slides.
9. The student is happy with the result and leaves her a positive review.
10. After doing a few more tasks, Lina starts enjoying the app because it lets her help others and build a good reputation at the same time.

Persona 3 - Harold Peterson (alone old person)

- Age 70
- Retired electrician
- Lives alone in an apartment
- Sometimes finds small physical tasks difficult
- Not very confident with modern apps
- Prefers simple and practical solutions
- Wants help without feeling like he is troubling others

Scenario - “want help in daily household tasks”

1. We meet Harold at home on a Saturday morning while he is making a list of things he needs to get done.
2. He needs groceries from downstairs and also wants to move a small table, but both feel harder now than they used to.
3. Harold does not like asking neighbours again and again for help unless it is really necessary.
4. One of his neighbours tells him about the app and explains that he can request help for small everyday tasks.
5. With a little help setting it up, Harold posts a request asking if someone nearby can help carry groceries and move a table.
6. After some time, a nearby helper accepts the request.
7. The helper comes over and finishes the task in a short time.
8. Harold feels comfortable because the process is simple and the help came quickly.
9. He leaves a positive review after the task is done.
10. From then on, he keeps the app as an option for those days when he needs a small extra hand.

Persona 4 - Ethan Clarke (working professional)

- Age 41
- Works as a marketing manager
- Has a busy work schedule
- Uses technology daily but is not good at fixing issues
- Gets frustrated when small tech problems waste his time
- Wants quick solutions so he can get back to work

Scenario - “good in his work but can’t solve tech problems”

1. We meet Ethan in his home office in the evening while he is preparing for an important meeting the next day.
2. He is almost done, but then his printer stops connecting to his laptop.
3. Ethan knows this is probably a small issue, but he also knows it could take a long time to figure out on his own.
4. Since he is already short on time, he opens the app and posts a request for help with the printer connection.
5. A helper who is good with tech accepts the request.
6. They communicate through chat, and the helper tells Ethan what settings to check.

7. After following the steps, Ethan gets the printer working again.
8. He is able to print his presentation and continue with the rest of his work.
9. He leaves a positive review because the help saved him time and stress.
10. After that, he sees the app as something useful for solving small problems quickly when work gets busy.

Requirements Generation:

- Registration / Login - receive bonus credits on first time register for posting some tasks
- User Profiles: users can create profiles with interests, skills, availability etc.
- Task posting: user should be able to post tasks with title, description, category, urgency level, estimated time etc.
- Task browsing and filters: search and filters by category, urgency, skill type, time and location
- Location based help: location services for tasks that require nearby or in person help, such as carrying groceries, moving items or household help
- In-app messaging/chat: to communicate to explain task, ask questions or clarify details
- Media sharing: to allow users to share screenshots, photos or short files especially for study help, technical problems or document related help
- Rating and review: feedback and rating system to build trust and credibility among users
- Credits/Reward system: users can earn credits for completed tasks and use credits to post task or they can donate
- Gamification and achievement badges: xp, level, badges, spinning wheels and achievements to motivate regular participation
- Challenges and streaks: daily or weekly challenges, activity streaks to keep users engaged
- Progress tracking dashboard: to see completed tasks, rating, earned credits, xp over time through dashboard
- Notifications and alerts: notify about new tasks, accepted requests, messages, completed tasks, rewards, reminders and urgent help requests
- Saved helpers: to save or bookmark trusted helpers to connect again in future
- Community engagement features: support a sense of community leaderboards, team participation and positive interaction between users
- Safety and trust: profile verifications, report users
- Buy credits: users who only want assistance and they ran out of credits, they can buy credits with money to post new tasks.

Synthesis of Requirements Gathering and Generation

Must Have Features (High priority)- These are the core features of the app that are essential for the basic functioning of the HelpLoop platform.

- User registration and login
- User profiles - with skills, interests and basic information
- Task posting system - with title, description, category, urgency, estimated time and credits
- Task browsing and filtering - by category, urgency, skill type and location
- In-app chat/messaging - for communication between requester and helper
- Task status tracking - such as posted, accepted, in progress and completed
- Notifications and alerts - for task updates, chat messages, accepted requests, and urgent help
- Ratings and reviews - to build trust between users
- Safety and trust features - such as profile verification, reporting users, and moderation support
- Starting credits for new users - so they can post their first tasks without difficulty
- Credit-based reward system - where helpers earn credits for completed tasks
- Subscription-based withdrawal option - so users can withdraw earned credits only after subscribing

Should Have Features (Medium priority)- These features are important to enhance user engagement, motivation and convenience.

- XP and leveling system - to reward regular participation
- Badges and achievements - for milestones, consistency, and quality of help
- Spin wheel / reward wheel - for bonus engagement and daily rewards
- Daily and weekly challenges - to keep users active
- Team-based challenges - where users can join teams and complete goals together
- Saved helpers / favorite helpers - so users can reconnect with trusted helpers
- Progress dashboard - showing completed tasks, earned credits, XP, badges, and reviews
- Media sharing - such as screenshots, images, or files for study or tech-related help
- Community goals - where users can contribute toward shared targets through earned credits or completed tasks
- Donation system - where users can contribute credits to student support, local causes, or community initiatives

Could Have Features (Low priority/Future enhancements)- These features are not essential but can be added later to improve user experience.

- Voice or video support for tasks that need live explanation
- AI-assisted matching or suggestions for finding suitable helpers faster
- Referral rewards for inviting new users
- Custom team events or seasonal challenges
- Advanced analytics for tracking user growth, engagement, and community contribution over time

AI Use Section

AI Tool Name	Version, ACcount Type	Specific feature for which the AI tool was used
ChatGPT	GPT- 5.2 / Plus	Used for minor support such as improving wording, grammar checking, refining sentence structure.
ChatGPT	GPT- 5.2 / Plus	Used to create visual images for personas.

Value addition

Most of the work for the HelpLoop project was completed by our team. We came up with the app idea ourselves, discussed the problem the app is solving, selected the target users, prepared the survey questions, collected the responses, analyzed the results, created the feature ideas, and decided the final requirements based on our own understanding of the project.

AI was used only in a limited way for support purposes. It was mainly used to improve grammar, make some sentences clearer, suggest better structure for parts of the written document, and generate a few images for personas. The main ideas, analysis, planning, and feature decisions were still done by our team.

Overall, AI was used only as a supporting tool for wording, structure, and some visuals, while the actual thinking, design decisions, and project development were done by the team.

Appendix:

Below is a summary of prompts used during the project planning phase:

- Generate reference images for each persona and scenario for presentation purposes.
- Help improve grammar and clarity in the written project document.
- Suggest a credit and reward system for a task-based community help app.

(Full conversation logs available upon request.)

Work Date/Hour Logs for student

Sehjalpreet Kaur

Date	Hours	Description of work
Jan 23, 2026	1.5	Brainstorming app idea and core features
Jan 25, 2026	2	Conducted background research and competitor analysis
Feb 01, 2026	1.5	Organised proposal structure and coordinated team input
Feb 06, 2026	4	Watched introductory Figma tutorial videos to understand figma and basic tools, learned about text styles, color styles, alignment tools, Practiced auto layout using sample UI components
Feb 09, 2026	3.5	Practiced creating reusable components in Figma, watched tutorials
Feb 11, 2026	2	Practiced prototyping simple navigation flows, watched tutorial on constraints
Feb 14, 2026	3	Explored community figma ideas, summarized key design concepts, completed learning Figma phase and applied skills to project UI
Feb 17, 2026	3.5	Designed initial app screens, created splash screen, login screen, and basic layout structure in figma
Feb 18, 2026	3	Designed home screen, refined UI consistency, spacing, visual hierarchy, implemented prototype interactions and tested navigation flow
Feb 21, 2026	1.5	Reviewed the requirements document template, studied and planned sections

Feb 23, 2026	3	Worked on requirements gathering sections, including objectives, target users and features of app, draft survey with questions
Feb 25, 2026	1	Reviewed questions for user study, refined and worked on features of app
Feb 27, 2026	2	Created and reviewed final questions for the survey in meeting with teammates and decided next steps
Mar 01, 2026	0.5	Shared the final survey to participants to collect feedback, reviewed the responses later
Mar 04, 2026	2.5	Created personas and wrote scenario drafts for different type of users
Mar 06, 2026	3.5	Reviewed teammates' scenarios and created features, and group and categorize all the features of app in a meeting with team members
Mar 08, 2026	2	Organized generated requirements, and worked on synthesis of requirement gathering and generation, worked on requirements document
Mar 09, 2026	2	Completed final edits for the document including all the sections, and formatting reviews.

Sungtae Kang

Date	Hours	Description of work
Jan 24, 2026	1.5	Researched gamification concepts and inspiration apps
Jan 26, 2026	1	Contributed to PACT and feature list
Jan 30, 2026	2	Reviewed proposal content and provided feedback
Feb 5, 2026	2	Studied how to use or utilize Figma by watching youtube
Feb 7, 2026	1.5	Creating Figma tutorials
Feb 12, 2026	1.5	Reviewed HelpLoop proposal and planned mobile screen structure based on project features.
Feb 15, 2026	2	Conducted design research on mobile UI patterns and reviewed gamification concepts to align prototype with project goals.
Feb 18, 2026	2	Developed detailed user personas based on target audience research and defined key user characteristics and goals.

Feb 22, 2026	1.5	Created user scenarios to map user journeys and interactions for the future step within the app.
Feb 25, 2026	2	Designed requirements gathering survey including objectives, categorized questions, and balanced rating scales.
Feb 27, 2026	2	Reviewed and refined survey questions in a meeting with teammates for clarity, consistency, and logical flow.
Mar 01, 2026	0.5	Distributed surveys to participants.
Mar 06, 2026	2	Reviewed teammates' scenarios in a team meeting, discussed feature ideas and helped categorize potential app features for the requirements document
Mar 09, 2026	1	Reviewed requirements Documents

Mani Singh

Date	Hours	Description of work
Jan 24, 2026	1.5	Helped define value proposition and app novelty
Jan 26, 2026	1	Assisted with project contract and feature refinement
Jan 30, 2026	2	Final proofreading and feedback of proposal
Feb 5, 2026	2	Reviewed the HelpLoop proposal and tried to plan the UI design structure of the mobile application.
Feb 7, 2026	1.5	Studied how to use or utilize Figma by watching youtube
Feb 12, 2026	1.5	Start creating Figma tutorials
Feb 15, 2026	2	Tried to create the initial app design using Figma based on the planned features and screen flow.
Feb 18, 2026	2	Reviewed the requirements document template and studied its structure to plan the sections needed for the project.
Feb 21, 2026	1.5	Start Working on requirements gathering sections, including defining objectives, identifying target users, outlining app features, and drafting survey questions

Feb 23, 2026	2	Reviewed and refined the user study questions and further worked on identifying potential features for the application.
Feb 27, 2026	2	Created and finalized the survey questions during a team meeting with teammates and discussed the next steps for data collection.
Mar 01, 2026	0.5	Shared the final survey with participants to collect feedback and later reviewed and analyzed the responses.
Mar 03, 2026	2	Created user personas and drafted scenarios representing different types of users interacting with the application.
Mar 06, 2026	3.5	Reviewed teammates' scenarios during a team meeting, identified additional features, and grouped and categorized the application features collaboratively.

Closing and References

Acknowledgement:

We would like to thank our instructor Prof. Padmapriya for guidance and feedback throughout the project ideation process. We appreciate the collaborative effort of all team members in developing and refining this project concept.

References:

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